

Ian Cowpar

Senior Product Manager · AI & Automation · Agentic Workflows · B2B SaaS

ian.cowpar@gmail.com · 351-235-0365 · linkedin.com/in/ian-cowpar · github.com/iancowpar · theunofficialleader.substack.com

SUMMARY

Senior product manager who builds AI capability platforms and the agentic-workflow scaffolding that lets teams operate AI inside real production systems. Two years owning product across a \$250M ARR enterprise B2B SaaS platform serving 300 customers at UKG, including the organization's first organized AI capability layer built from zero with no top-down mandate, and a personal Claude Code productivity OS of twenty custom slash commands in active daily use. Prototypes in Claude Code, scopes with platform architects as a peer, ships AI as embedded product capability rather than bolted-on feature. A decade prior at Broadridge in compliance-grade financial services, where client confidentiality and regulatory consequence were the operating environment. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework, with weekly published thought leadership on AI adoption realism.

SELECTED OUTCOMES

- **Built UKG product organization's first organized AI capability platform and the agentic-workflow infrastructure underneath it.** Scaled shared infrastructure across 20 PMs with no top-down mandate, including a personal Claude Code productivity OS of twenty custom slash commands that automated multi-step PM workflows. Multiple PMs went on to build their own agentic workflows and retired manual processes entirely. Adoption measured by what stopped, not what launched.
- **Shipped agentic AI as a first-class product feature**, embedding a Claude Code function as the routing layer inside an opinionated analytics product that surfaced the single highest-leverage action across five issue panels spanning customer escalations, code defects, internal bugs, CVEs, and noise. Cut a working defect list from ~200 issues to 5 (~97%).
- **Shipped a zero-to-one self-serve product from concept to production in a one-week prototype cycle.** Wrote the prototype in Claude Code, scoped three business epics with the platform architect to define what was actually buildable, delivered an engineering-ready package the architect built directly against. Projected ~30% time reduction in a ticket-gated enterprise workflow.
- **Built a composite ARR-risk model that surfaced ~\$50M in at-risk accounts before escalation**, scoring top accounts on exposure, case volume, true-defect rate, and sentiment, replacing raw ticket counts with weighted signal and an automated weekly cadence the program lead acted on.
- **Drove cross-functional prioritization across product, engineering, and services without direct authority**, translating customer signal from executive escalation rooms into tradeoff decisions across four product lines on a \$250M ARR platform serving 300 customers.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Product Manager · UKG · Lowell, MA · Jun 2024 – Apr 2026

Senior product ownership across AI capability, agentic workflows, and data products serving 300 enterprise customers on a \$250M ARR B2B SaaS platform.

- **Built the organization's first AI capability platform from zero, including the agentic-workflow layer beneath it**, scaling across 20 PMs without mandate. Multiple PMs developed their own custom slash commands and retired manual workflows entirely.
- **Shipped agentic AI inside a product** by embedding a Claude Code function as the routing layer in a five-panel analytics product spanning customer escalations, code defects, internal bugs, CVEs, and noise, cutting a working defect list ~97%.
- **Shipped a zero-to-one self-serve product concept-to-production in one week**, prototyped in Claude Code and scoped with the platform architect as a peer, projected to cut ~30% from a

ticket-gated enterprise workflow.

- **Owned the upgrade program's data products:** a composite ARR-risk model that surfaced ~\$50M at risk before escalation, and an opinionated analytics product with embedded agentic AI driving prioritization.

Drove cross-functional prioritization in executive escalation rooms across four product lines. Brand Champion, UKG North America Regional Lead 2026; Fire Up ERG (women and allies), Business Innovation workstream lead.

Business Analyst · Broadridge Financial Solutions · Andover, MA · Jan 2014 – Jun 2024

Forty-plus enterprise SaaS deployments end-to-end in compliance-grade financial services, where client confidentiality and regulatory consequence shaped every delivery decision.

- **Led 40+ enterprise SaaS client deployments end-to-end** in a regulated financial services environment where a wrong output had regulatory consequence, not a bug ticket; partnered with engineering on system behavior, data flows, and integration dependencies.
- **Served as internal subject-matter expert for an omni-channel communication product adopted across the entire enterprise client base**, translating complex compliance capabilities into workflows non-technical buyers could operate without support.

Senior Document Development Analyst · Broadridge Financial Solutions · Andover, MA · Jan 2006 – Jan 2014

Built and maintained complex client-facing document and communication systems in a regulated financial services environment.

SKILLS AND FOCUS AREAS

AI & Agentic Workflows: AI capability platform building, agentic workflow design and deployment, embedded AI as first-class product feature, LLM-powered product features, twenty custom slash commands and a personal Claude Code productivity OS in active daily use, MCP-based integrations, prompt and tool design, AI adoption measurement (extinction over addition)

Technical Credibility: Claude Code prototyping, API specs and integration dependencies, Slack MCP, deployment-model and platform product thinking, technical-systems fluency with engineering, scoping directly with platform architects as a peer, SQL

Product Strategy & Leadership: Senior product management scope, product vision and roadmap, OKR-to-execution, prioritization in ambiguous spaces, cross-functional leadership without direct authority, mentorship of PMs and building communities of users and champions, Agile / Scrum, B2B SaaS

Data & Experimentation: Opinionated analytics products, composite scoring and risk modeling, success-metric and KPI definition, hypothesis-driven development, signal-versus-noise routing

Enterprise SaaS: Compliance-grade regulated delivery, client confidentiality as table stakes, enterprise customer escalation-room presence, multi-org program coordination, stakeholder management

Tooling: Jira, Confluence, GitHub, SQL, Claude Code CLI, Slack MCP, Salesforce Service Cloud (operator)

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Management Information Systems and Management

Manning School of Business, UMass Lowell · 1999

WRITING AND THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

The Unofficial Leader (Substack) · theunofficialleader.substack.com

Weekly publication on where AI actually earns its place, adoption realism, and what's happening beneath the surface of how teams work. Originator of the Zero-Translation Building framework.